

ABHIJIT GUPTA | 41
READER, Jadavpur University,
 Kolkata

THE WORLD AS HIS OYSTER

Abhijit Gupta wrote a thesis on 19th century women novelists in 1996 for his doctoral degree, but has since moved out completely from that line of research. Over the past few years, he has been studying printing in 19th century Bengal, and also has been working in what may broadly be called digital humanities. His teaching is a mix of the old and the new: Victorian and 20th century literature on the one hand and new genres like

graphic novels, science-fiction and modernist poetry on the other. The department of English at the university is the only one in the country which teaches a half-course on graphic novels to all undergraduates. At various times, he has taught courses on literature and censorship, the French Revolution, R.L. Stevenson and Herman Melville. Outside the campus, he works with students in running an NGO which tries to generate employment opportunities for disadvantaged youth in three districts of rural Bengal. Their work consists of researching and designing training courses, raising funds, administering training and making regular visits to the project sites.

by Abhijit Dasgupta

Pet subjects The Victorian novel, science fiction, modernist poetry and graphic novels.

Loves To play corridor cricket with his students once the college hours are over.

Mantra for change Encourages students to be themselves and not clones of their teachers.

SHAILESH SHIRALI | 54 **TEACHER**, Rishi Valley, Andhra Pradesh

MATH MAKER

For Shailesh Shirali, teaching and learning mathematics is the joy of life. This is why the Ph.D in Operations Research from University of Texas, US, found his calling as a mathematics teacher in Rishi Valley School near Madanapalle, Andhra Pradesh. Talking to children about mathematics and astronomy while watching and taking care of animals are what make him tick. A follower of J. Krishnamurti, Shirali has published several highly appreciated papers even as he conducts mathematics workshops across the country.

by Amarnath K. Menon

Pet project The Community Mathematics Centre at Rishi Valley, which serves as a resource centre for teachers.

Loves Songs of Bob Dylan and Joan Baez.

Mantra for change Let children grow up, though slowly.

SANJAY RAMCHANDRAN

"They say if you haven't learnt maths from Shirali, you haven't learnt it at all."

Anurag Sangal, Educational Consultant, Dehradun



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